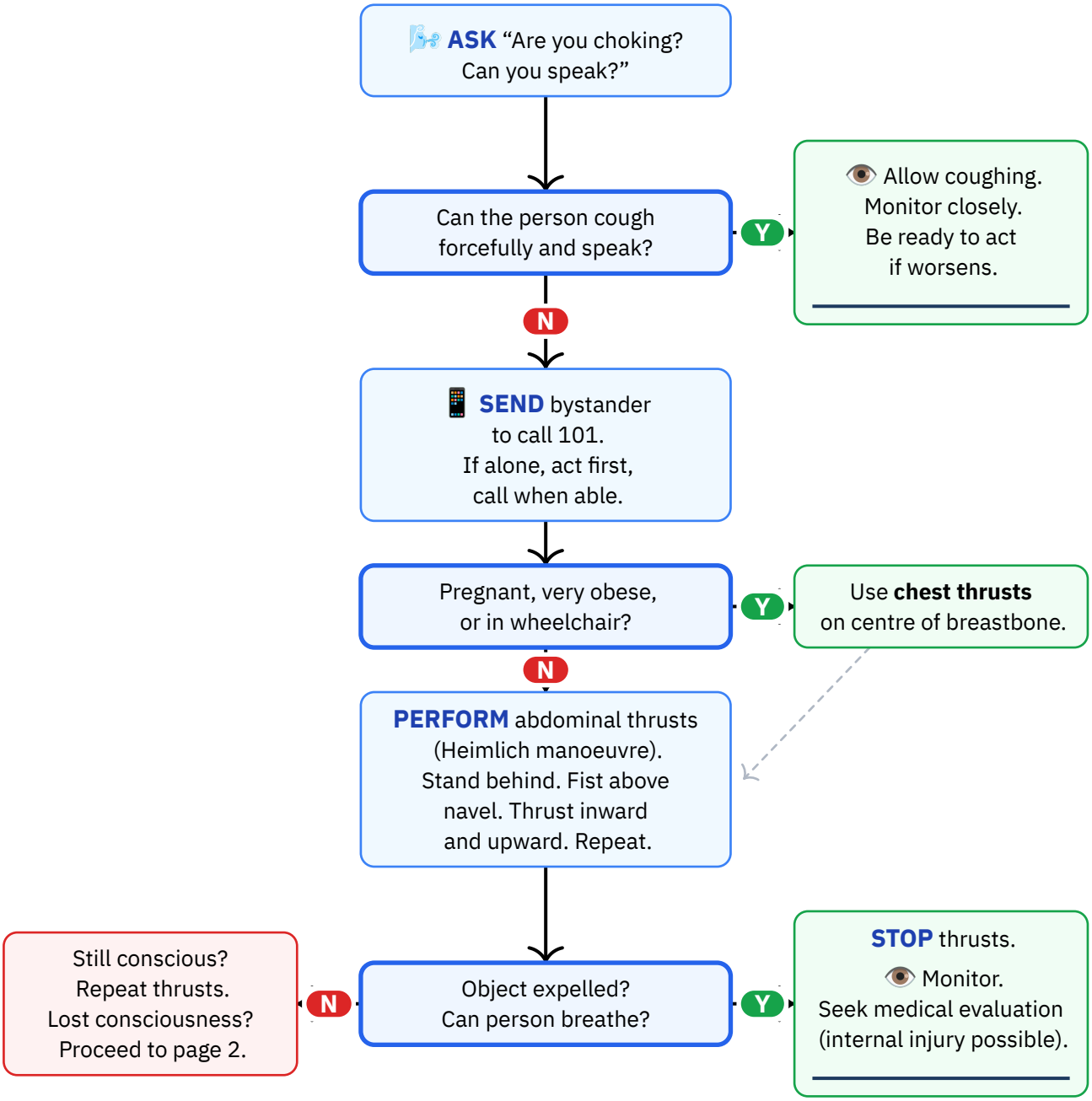

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Unconscious Choking & Self-Treatment

🧑 **LOWER** person carefully to firm, flat surface.

📱 **CALL** 101 if not already done.

❤️ **BEGIN** CPR: 30 compressions, 2 breaths. Before each breath, look in mouth for visible object.

Object visible in mouth?

- **Y** → **REMOVE** with finger sweep.
- **N** → ❤️ Continue CPR cycles (30:2) until MDA arrives or person recovers.

Self-Treatment if Choking Alone

LEAN over a firm object (chair back, countertop edge).
PRESS upper abdomen forcefully against the object.
Repeat until the object is expelled.
📱 **CALL** 101 as soon as you can speak.

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Reference Notes

DO NOT:

✕ **Do NOT perform abdominal thrusts on a person who can cough and speak** – you may worsen the obstruction.
✕ **Do NOT perform back blows on an adult** – MDA/Israeli protocol explicitly describes this as incorrect and potentially harmful for adults.
✕ **Do NOT perform blind finger sweeps** – only remove an object if you can clearly see it.
✕ **Do NOT give water or liquid** to a choking person.
✕ **Do NOT continue abdominal thrusts on an unconscious person** – transition to CPR.
✕ **Do NOT use abdominal thrusts on pregnant or very obese individuals** – use chest thrusts instead.

Note: Israeli Protocol Divergence

MDA/Israeli protocol **does not recommend back blows** for adults. This differs from AHA (2025) which recommends alternating 5 back blows and 5 abdominal thrusts, and from ERC (2025) which recommends 5 back blows first. Follow MDA guidance when in Israel.

Hebrew Terminology — מונחים בעברית

English	עברית	Pronunciation
Choking	חנק	KHE-nek
Foreign body	גוף זר	guf zar
Can you breathe?	אתה יכול לנשום?	a-TA ya-KHOL lin-SHOM?
Can you speak?	אתה יכול לדבר?	a-TA ya-KHOL le-da-BER?
Cough	שיעול	shi-UL
Stomach / abdomen	בטן	BE-ten
Chest	חזה	kha-ZE
Ambulance	אמבולנס	am-bu-LANS
Emergency	חירום	khe-RUM
Are you choking?	אתה נחנק?	a-TA nekh-NAK?

Source: Magen David Adom (MDA) — How to Treat Choking from a Foreign Body
URL: https://www.mdais.org/101/asphyxia
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